GR-012

Three-Pilot Comparison & Final Design Recommendations

Human Operating Readiness across HRBP Manager, Recruiter and CHRO

Prepared by GiGi Garcia for joint review with Timothy King

November 3, 2026

Working conclusion
The three pilots support keeping the GR-012 instrument intact. The same ten dimensions worked across operational, managerial and executive roles without being rewritten. What the pilots do not prove yet is actual organizational readiness or which candidate gates are universally hard gates, because organization-specific evidence was deliberately absent. That distinction matters.

Purpose

Turn the three pilot tests into a clear design decision: what held, what changed by role level, what should be locked into GR-012, and what should remain provisional until we have real organizational evidence.

1. What I Think the Three Pilots Actually Proved

I ran the same ten Human Operating Readiness dimensions across three very different roles on purpose. HRBP Manager gave us judgment-heavy employee relations work. Recruiter gave us high-volume, legally exposed operational work. CHRO gave us executive-level governance and accountability work. If the instrument had to be rewritten for each one, that would have been a problem.

It did not. The same ten dimensions remained useful across all three roles. What changed was the kind of evidence each role would need and the shape of the human risk. That is exactly what I wanted to see.

Important limitation
All three pilots remained Insufficient Evidence because we did not have organization-specific proof. That means these pilots validate the structure and evidence discipline of GR-012. They do not establish that any real organization is Ready, Conditional or Not Ready, and they do not yet empirically confirm universal hard gates.

Pilot snapshot

Pilot	Activity	Consequence	Operating shape	Main human question	Result
HRBP Manager	7.4.4 Manage employee grievances	Critical	Managerial; one role carries the core judgment and accountability	Can the HRBP Manager actually override, challenge, review and escalate AI-supported grievance work?	Insufficient Evidence
Recruiter	7.2.3.4 Select and reject candidates	Critical	Operational; Director of TA + Recruiter materially touch the work	Can the Recruiter challenge AI rankings under volume pressure while accountability remains clear across roles?	Insufficient Evidence
CHRO	7.1.1.2 Define HR and business function roles and accountability	High	Executive; CHRO is top-of-catalog with Director of HR Ops materially involved	Can the CHRO make a trustworthy executive judgment with real governance challenge above the role?	Insufficient Evidence

The common finding was not that the roles were unready. The common finding was that the reference model could tell us what the role was supposed to do, but not whether a real organization had made that responsibility operational. That is the exact gap GR-012 is supposed to expose.

2. Dimension-by-Dimension Comparison

Because all three pilots stayed at Insufficient Evidence, the useful comparison is not the color. The useful comparison is what each dimension demanded from the organization and whether the same question still made sense at a different level of work.

Dimension	What repeated across all three	Role-level difference that mattered	Design implication
Role Clarity	Reference design can define the intended human/AI boundary, but operating evidence is still required.	HRBP = grievance boundary; Recruiter = screening/ranking vs. select/reject; CHRO = AI-supported input vs. executive accountability.	Keep dimension unchanged. Design clarity is not operating readiness.
Decision Authority	Formal accountability did not prove practical authority to stop, reject, override or escalate.	Recruiter needs system/operating authority under volume; CHRO needs an executive challenge and escalation path, not just title authority.	Strong gate candidate. Separate formal accountability from usable authority.
Capability / Skill	Each role needs case-based evidence that it can detect weak, incomplete or inappropriate AI-supported work.	The content changes by role: grievance reasoning, candidate bias/quality, governance/accountability design.	Keep dimension unchanged; evidence scenarios must be role-specific.
Confidence / Decision Fluency	Capability is not enough; the person must actually act when AI and human judgment disagree.	CHRO adds executive/political pressure; Recruiter adds volume/system-authority pressure; HRBP adds high-stakes case pressure.	Keep separate from Capability. Test observed behavior, not self-report.
Psychological Safety	A formal escalation path does not prove it is safe to use.	For CHRO, safety includes the ability to dissent from executive preference or AI-supported analysis.	Keep dimension unchanged. Likely context-sensitive gate.
Capacity / Workload	AI may remove routine work while concentrating review, exception and judgment burden.	HRBP = case load/verification tax; Recruiter = hiring volume; CHRO = executive attention and cognitive bandwidth.	Keep dimension unchanged. Do not infer capacity from automation savings.
Manager / Governance-Oversight Readiness	A named reporting or escalation relationship is not proof that oversight can absorb the new model.	CHRO requires a Governance/Oversight Body variant because there is no normal manager above the role.	Keep dimension; retain top-of-catalog governance variant.
Leadership Support / Governance	Every pilot needed organization-specific stop conditions, escalation rights and failure ownership.	The governance mechanism becomes more formal as consequence and role level rise.	Strong context-dependent gate candidate, especially for High/Critical work.
Change Capacity	Readiness is time-bound. A good design can still be badly timed.	The source of strain differs: staffing and volume at lower levels; executive bandwidth and competing strategy at CHRO level.	Keep organization-specific and time-bound.
Trust / Evidence Quality	GR-012 must consume technical/process evidence rather than re-test the technology.	The evidence must be understandable to the role using it, from Recruiter to CHRO.	Strong gate candidate. Require traceable provenance and limitations.

3. Hard Gates: What I Would Lock and What I Would Not

The pilots do not give me enough evidence to declare six universal hard gates. Every finding stayed at Insufficient Evidence, so we never observed a real dimension move to Ready, Conditional or Not Ready. I do not want to turn a design hypothesis into a permanent rule just because it sounds sensible.

What the pilots did give me is a clearer hierarchy of gate candidates.

Category	Dimensions	My recommendation
Strongest universal gate candidates	Decision Authority; Capability / Skill; Trust / Evidence Quality	Keep as candidate hard gates and prioritize them in the first real-organization validation. Without usable authority, enough skill, or evidence fit for reliance, meaningful human control is difficult to defend.
Likely transition-specific gates	Psychological Safety; Capacity / Workload; Leadership Support / Governance	Allow these to become gates when the transition and consequence make failure materially unsafe or non-credible. Do not force them into universal gate status yet.
Important but not universal gate	Manager / Governance-Oversight Readiness	Treat as a transition-specific stop condition when the operating model depends on active coaching, escalation absorption or governance challenge.
Diagnostic dimensions	Role Clarity; Confidence / Decision Fluency; Change Capacity	Keep fully visible. These can still stop a transition in practice, but the pilots did not support labeling them universal hard gates.

My position
For v0.2, I would keep the hard-gate list provisional. The next validation should use a real organization where at least some findings can move off Gray. That is the point at which we can say a dimension actually behaved like a stop condition rather than only looking like one on paper.

4. Weakest-Link Rule

The three pilots support keeping weakest-link, but with a tighter rule than simply “take the worst score.”

- Use weakest-link for High/Critical work across materially required operational Accountable/Responsible roles.
- Do not average role findings. One weak required role should not disappear inside a stronger composite result.
- Do not automatically include Consulted or Informed roles in the roll-up.
- Keep the Governance/Oversight Body separate unless it has a true operational RACI responsibility for the activity.
- If only one materially required operational role exists, weakest-link is not a meaningful roll-up; assess that role directly and test governance separately.
- If any materially required role remains Insufficient Evidence, the overall result cannot be stronger than Insufficient Evidence for that transition.

5. GR-013 Human Agency / Meaningful Human Control

The pilots strengthened my view that Human Agency should stay visible, but it should not become an eleventh GR-012 dimension or another score.

Definition
Human Agency is whether the person can actually exercise the judgment and accountability the operating model leaves with them - including the practical ability to understand, question, challenge, override, pause and escalate AI-supported work when appropriate.

What changed across the pilots was the shape of agency, not the need for it:

- HRBP Manager: Can the role challenge or override an AI-supported precedent or recommendation and still own the grievance judgment?
- Recruiter: Can the role challenge a ranking or screening recommendation under real hiring volume and legal exposure?
- CHRO: Does the executive have trustworthy input, independent judgment and credible governance challenge to make a high-leverage accountability decision well?

My recommendation is to derive Human Agency especially from Decision Authority, Capability/Skill, Confidence/Decision Fluency, Psychological Safety, Capacity/Workload and Trust/Evidence Quality, with governance context added where the role sits at the top of the structure.

6. Human Intensity / GR-018

I would keep Human Intensity qualitative in v0.2. The pilots reinforce why a single number would be premature.

- HRBP grievance work can become less administrative but more emotionally and relationally intense.
- Recruiting can become less sourcing-heavy but more concentrated around ambiguous, high-consequence candidate decisions.
- CHRO work can be low-frequency but very high in cognitive load and organizational consequence.

The High/Critical share of work, verification load, exception load and escalation concentration are useful evidence signals. They are not Human Intensity by themselves. I would not convert exposure counts into hours, effort or burden without observed data.

7. Who Determines the Findings

The pilots intentionally left Assessed by, Evidence gathered from and Findings signed off by blank. I think we now need a simple governance rule that protects independence without turning the instrument into bureaucracy.

Field	Recommended rule	Why
Assessed by	A trained assessor/facilitator who is not the sole role holder and, where practical, is independent of the system owner.	The role holder should inform the finding, not grade their own readiness alone.
Evidence gathered from	Role holder, manager or governance body, technical/process owner, relevant policies, system permissions, operating records and observed scenarios.	GR-012 needs both human and operating evidence, while technical validation remains in its own lane.
Finding sign-off	Low/Moderate: Accountable business owner + assessor. High/Critical: cross-functional review or panel sign-off that includes business/HR, governance/risk and technical/process evidence ownership as relevant.	Higher-consequence transitions deserve an extra check without averaging away disagreement.

8. Did GR-012 Hold Without Modification?

Yes - at the level that matters most for this stage of the work.

The same ten dimensions were usable across all three pilots without adding, dropping or redefining a dimension. The pilots produced different role-specific questions and evidence needs, but that is a sign the instrument is doing its job. A reusable instrument should not force identical findings; it should surface the right operating question for the role in front of it.

The pilots did expose three application rules that should be made explicit in the tested version of v0.2:

- Use a Governance/Oversight Body variant for top-of-catalog roles such as CHRO.
- Apply weakest-link only to materially required operational A/R roles in High/Critical work.
- Keep Human Agency as a derived finding rather than embedding it as an eleventh dimension.

Those are refinements to how GR-012 is applied, not evidence that the ten-dimension instrument needs to be redesigned.

9. Final Design Recommendations for GR-012 v0.2

Lock the ten dimensions: Keep the current ten-dimension set. Do not add or drop dimensions based on these pilots.

Keep the four finding states: Ready, Conditional, Not Ready and Insufficient Evidence. Gray remains a legitimate outcome, not a failure.

Keep the evidence rule: A modeled concern may not move a finding. Organization-specific evidence is required.

No composite readiness percentage: Keep the narrative conclusion and visible evidence/gap/action trail.

Keep hard gates provisional: Prioritize Decision Authority, Capability/Skill and Trust/Evidence Quality in the first real-organization gate validation; allow other dimensions to act as transition-specific gates.

Adopt the refined weakest-link rule: High/Critical, materially required operational A/R roles only; governance separate unless operational.

Formalize GR-013 as derived: Meaningful Human Control stays distinct, visible and non-scored.

Keep Human Intensity qualitative: Use exposure and consequence measures as inputs, not as a proxy score.

Add finding-governance rules: Specify assessor, evidence sources and sign-off path by consequence level.

Preserve provenance everywhere: Assessed vs. Modeled, evidence type, source, reference, confidence, coverage, date and limitations should travel with the finding.

Keep Unassessed visibly unknown: Related dependency: an organization with no assessment evidence should not silently inherit a Human-only Current State as though it were observed fact.

Do not automate scoring yet: The next proof point is a real-organization assessment where findings can move off Gray.

10. What I Would Do Next

The three pilots got us to the end of the design-pressure-test phase. I would not run more model-only pilots just to create more rows. The next work should make the methodology operational.

Step	Next move	What I mean
1	Update GR-012 v0.2 once	Fold in the pilot comparison, refined weakest-link rule, finding-governance rule, GR-013 relationship and Human Intensity decision. Do not rewrite the core instrument.
2	Formalize GR-013	Write the derived Human Agency finding into the framework and define how its inputs are read from GR-012.
3	Close GR-018 for this version	Record Human Intensity as qualitative for v0.2 and identify the evidence signals it may use.
4	Use GR-019 as the judgment-development companion	The Recruiter judgment-building path should sit beside readiness so AI does not remove the experiences people need to become capable decision-makers.
5	Define GR-022 pre-transition validation	Specify who participates, what evidence must exist before progression, and how the pre-transition check relates to GR-012.
6	Validate with a real organization	The next meaningful test is one where evidence can actually move dimensions from Insufficient Evidence to Ready, Conditional or Not Ready.
7	Only then revisit hard-gate automation	Once real findings exist, determine which dimensions truly stop progression and whether any automated roll-up is defensible.

11. The Bottom Line

My recommendation to Tim
Keep GR-012. The three pilots show that the same readiness architecture can hold across very different roles without flattening the human differences between them. What we have validated is the instrument and its evidence discipline, not organizational readiness. The next version should lock the parts that held, keep the gate logic provisional where the evidence is still thin, and move the next test into a real organization where the findings can actually change.

This is the point where the work shifts from “Does the instrument make sense?” to “Can the instrument support a real progression decision with traceable evidence?” That is the test I would use before we automate anything further.

Working basis

Prepared from the GR-012 Human Operating Readiness v0.2 working specification, the completed HRBP Manager grievance pressure test, the Working-Relationship Progression methodology, and the Recruiter and CHRO pilot records completed in the GR-012 readiness worksheet. This is a design recommendation for joint review, not a claim of organization-specific readiness.